



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

Dec 2018

Inside this issue:

<i>Calendar</i>	2
<i>Worship Schedule</i>	3
<i>Youth & Children</i>	4
<i>New Organist</i>	5
<i>Poinsettias</i>	7
<i>Toy Drive</i>	8
<i>Winter Retreat</i>	9,10
<i>Pastor's Message</i>	11

December

SUNDAY WORSHIP SCHEDULE

9:00 AM WORSHIP WITH ORGAN AND CHOIR.

10:00 am Education & Fellowship

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in December

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
Notes: The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.						1 World AIDS Day Advent Festival 8a Brighter Minds Music 9a BMM 9:30a BMM
2 Advent begins Communion 9a Worship with Organ 10:15a Sunday School 10:15a Young Family Sunday School 11a Worship with Band 3p M'haha Women's Group 3p Youth Group 6:30p Scouts PPM 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	3 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p World Religions - Roman Catholic & Orthodox Christianity	4 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	5 10a Staff Meeting 5:30p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. night dinners 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	6 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 9:30a M'haha Playgroup 2:30p BMM 4:30p BMM	7 10a AI-Anon 6:30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA 7p Movie Night	8 8a Brighter Minds Music 9a BMM 9:30a BMM 9:30a Newcomer Class
9 9a Worship with Organ 10:15a Sunday School 11a Worship with Band 3p Youth Group 7p SAA	10 Human Rights Day 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts/Den Meetings 6:30p World Religions - Protestant Christianity	11 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM	12 5p Piano Tune 5:30p Methodicals 5:30p Pageant Rehearsal/Dinner 5:30p Wed. night dinners 6:45p Chancel Choir	13 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a BMM 9:30a M'haha Playgroup 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p BMM 4:30p Brighter Minds	14 Newsletter items due 10a AI-Anon 6:30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA 7p Blue Christmas Taizé 7p Fellowship Hall reserved	15 MinneHarvest 7a BMM 8a BMM 9a BMM 9:30a BMM 5p Potluck
16 9a Worship with Organ 10:15a Sunday School 11a Worship with Band 4p Pageant and dinner 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	17 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts Pack Meeting	18 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM 6:30p Toastmasters	19 5:30p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. night dinners 6:45p Chancel Choir	20 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a BMM 9:30a M'haha Playgroup 2:30p BMM 4:30p Brighter Minds	21 Winter Solstice 9a Newsletter Collation 10a AI-Anon 6:30p RCA	22 8a BMM 9a BMM 9:30a BMM
23 9a Worship with Organ 10:15a Sunday School 11a Worship with Band 7p SAA	24 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3p BMM 4p Christmas Eve Worship 10p Christmas Eve Worship	25 Christmas	26 10:30a Food Shelf 5:30p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. night dinners 6:45p Chancel Choir	27 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a BMM 9:30a M'haha Playgroup 2:30p BMM 4:30p Brighter Minds	28 10a AI-Anon 6:30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	29 8a BMM 9a BMM 9a BMM 9:30a BMM
30 12a BMM 10a Worship 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	31 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 3p BMM	Good Things Happen is the newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church, published each month. The deadline for January is December 14 Contributions may be brought to the office or emailed to: office@minnehaha.org 3701 East 50th Street Minneapolis, MN 55417				

Worship in December

We'll be walking through the Magnificat (Mary's song during her pregnancy) during the Sundays in Advent this year. Our coloring posters also match the theme of the Magnificat, and we have an Advent Devotional available as well. Normally confined to just one Sunday in Advent, we'll have four Sundays to explore the depth of this beautiful song. The last Sunday in December (after Christmas), we'll just have one service at 10:00, and it will be a hymn-sing. Your last chance to get in all those Christmas hymns you didn't get a chance to sing yet! See you in worship.

2nd	"My Spirit Rejoices in God"	Luke 1:46-50
	<i>Communion</i>	
9th	"The Hungry are Fed"	Luke 1:51-53
16th	"God's Promises"	Luke 1:54-55
23rd	"Love Wins"	Luke 1:39-45, 56
	<i>9:00 Baptism of Parker & Rylan Hicks</i>	
24th	4:00 Informal Service	
	10:00 Traditional Service with candles	
30th	One service at 10:00—Hymn sing	

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- Jan. 9 – Food Shelf Pasta Dinner at Lake Nokomis Lutheran Church
- Jan. 13 – Infant Recognition
- Jan. 20 – Annual Meeting
- Jan. 25-27 – Winter Retreat at Koronis Assembly Grounds
- Feb. 9-10 – Annual Musical
- Feb. 10 – Camping Sunday
- Feb. 23 – My Changing Self Workshop for children and youth
- Feb. 23-26 – Special United Methodist General Conference in St. Louis, MO
- March 6 – Ash Wednesday (beginning of Lent)
- March 16 – Scouts Pinewood Derby

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

Minnehaha Children, Youth, and Family Ministries



And, just like that, Advent is here. At Minnehaha, that means Christmas Pageant preparations are under way, the Advent Wreath is set, plans are being made for Christmas Eve services. At stores, it means holiday displays and sales are in full force. It coincides with our approach to the Winter Solstice - with nights getting longer and longer.

What does it mean in our homes? To our families? To our children? Advent is the season of waiting - of anticipation and reflection. As we move closer to Christmas, to celebrating the birth of Jesus, we're reminded of the intense need for hope, peace, joy, and love. We're reminded how much we need light in the darkness. So, how can we make space in our busy days to nurture - in ourselves & others - hope and wonder?

We hope that some of our offerings at Minnehaha this Advent will help you with this challenge. I encourage you to carefully peruse the opportunities this month at Minnehaha to seek, serve, and celebrate: opportunities to pause together amidst the chaos (wonderful as it may be) of this time of year to bring light to the world.

"The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness has not overcome it." - John 1:5

Happy Advent & Merry Christmas,

Jenia Strom
Interim Director of Children & Family
Ministries



YOUTH @ Minnehaha UMC

December at Minnehaha

All Church Advent Party: Saturday, 1st from 9:30-11:30am
Paint windows! Set-up trees! Eat donuts! Make origami stars! (& deck the halls for Advent at Minnehaha)

Sunday Mornings - Dec. 2nd, 9th, & 16th at 10:15am: We'll be getting ready for the pageant & the youth orchestra will practice at 11am

Sunday Afternoon - Dec. 2nd from 3-4:30pm: Middle School Youth Group (6th & 7th graders) and Confirmation (8th & 9th graders)

Wednesday, Dec. 5th: Minnehaha Youth Group (6th-12th) from 6:15-7pm: We'll be getting set for our caroling party - picking favorite songs, etc.

Sunday, Dec. 9th: Minnehaha Youth Group (6th-12th) from 3-6pm: **Caroling Party** We'll be visiting the VA and Nokomis Square before returning to Minnehaha for hot chocolate & cookies

Wednesday, Dec. 12th: Minnehaha Youth Group (6th-12th): We'll be rehearsing for the Christmas Pageant at 6:15, the Youth Orchestra will rehearse separately at 7pm.

Sunday, Dec. 16th: Christmas Pageant at 4pm, followed by dinner

Sunday, Dec. 23rd: Sunday School at 10:15, but no afternoon youth group this week or next!

Monday, Dec. 24th: Christmas Eve Worship at 4pm and 10pm

Merry Christmas & Happy New Year!



December Children & Family Events

Saturday, 1st: Advent Party from 9:30 to 11:30am

Sundays, 2nd, 9th, 16th, & 23rd: Worship & Sunday School – we'll be preparing for the Christmas Pageant during the Sunday School Hour

Wednesday, 5th: Dinner from 5:30-6:22pm & Programming from 6:15-7pm

Sunday, 9th: Young Family Sunday School at 10:15am

Wednesday, 12th: Dinner from 5:30-6:22pm & Pageant Rehearsal from 6:15-7pm

Sunday, 16th: Christmas Pageant at 4pm, followed by an all church dinner & cookie decorating

Monday, 24th: Christmas Eve Worship at 4pm and 10pm

Sunday, 30th: One worship service at 10am (no Sunday School)

Minnehaha's December Potluck:

A smorgasbord of food, laughter and music for Minnehaha adults of all ages Saturday, December 15th, from 5:30 – 9 pm
Where: Becketwood (4300 W River Pkwy, Mpls)
Bring a dish to share, a favorite Christmas memory, and your favorite Christmas carol
R.S.V.P tracygulliver@gmail.com or 651-274-1657

One-Service Sundays

On December 30, the Sunday after Christmas, there will be no Sunday School, and we'll worship together at one service at 10:00. Join us for a festive morning of celebration with a hymn-sing!

Church Musical

The All Church Silly Family Musical will begin rehearsal on Sunday, Jan. 6. at 6:00 in the Fellowship Hall. We will be performing Feb. 9 and 10 with many early evenings of rehearsals. Please let Maureen Trepp know if you are a singer or actress or actor or just want to be in a show; you do need to be at least 6 years old and in 1st grade, please. You can call her at 612-724-7620.

New Organist

Anders Nelson

SPR is delighted to welcome our new organist, Anders Nelson! Anders will start as our organist and choir accompanist in January, although you may see him around before then practicing the organ and learning the choir anthems that will be coming up in January. In addition, A.P. Hopper has graciously agreed to stay on as our substitute choir director. We are now posting for just that position (rather than the combined organist/choir director position), and we hope to have someone in place by summer.

Anders started attending Minnehaha when he was three years old. He developed a love of music at an early age, and is so thankful for the opportunities Minnehaha gave him to play as a kid. He has a B.A. in music from UW-Eau Claire and is currently back in school at Dunwoody College of Technology for a B.S. in software engineering. He is very excited to be back at Minnehaha, and is looking forward to lots of growth and great music over the coming years. Anders currently lives in Roseville with his girlfriend Rachel, who is finishing her master's degree in Communication Sciences and Disorders, and will be entering the workforce as a speech-language pathologist in the fall.

MINNEHARVEST

a food mission of minnehaha united methodist church

One out of six Minnesotans goes hungry on a regular basis. Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us this month on Saturday, December 15 (a week earlier than usual due to Christmas). You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food at 9:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us, and bring a friend!

United Methodist Women

We will be serving food on Dec. 26 at Simpson Shelter and can always use volunteers. You can meet at church to carpool at 5:15 or at Simpson any time after 5:30. It usually takes until 8:15 to serve and clean up. We can also always use people to prepare the meal, this time probably on Dec. 26 as we're all pretty busy before Xmas. Please let Maureen Trepp know if you're interested.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

A brief service of communion is offered at Nokomis Square on the second Thursday of this month. All are welcome to join us on December 13 at 1:00 p.m.

MINNEHAHA UMC INVITES YOU TO

**YOUNG FAMILY
SUNDAY SCHOOL
SUNDAY, 9TH DEC.
AT 10:15AM**

Babies & toddlers & their caregivers are invited for story time, songs, ornament making, and fellowship.
Join us in room 204 (the child care room). Questions?
Contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org or 612.721.6231

Feeling a Little Blue for Christmas

Sure, there's lots to be joyful about as we approach Christmas, but the shorter days and colder temperatures don't leave everyone full of good cheer. Add in a feeling of frenzy from the rush of the season, and it already begins to feel a little overwhelming. Add in even more, a job loss or change, the loss of a loved one, a change in health, a strained friendship, a move, and it can begin to feel like we are out of sync with the joy being expressed at every turn.

You are invited to rest awhile in silence, in quiet music, and in the glow of candlelight as we observe our Blue Christmas Taizé service on December 14 at 7:00 p.m. Whether you need an opportunity to just sit still for a little bit, or you are looking for a way to acknowledge feelings of loss or depression, join with others for an hour of reflection and rest as we continue to find God's presence in the midst of wherever we are.

"A Wise Man's Journey to Bethlehem"

Christmas Pageant



The Christmas story told as you've never seen it.
Christmas Carols! Kids! Camels! Puppets! Stars! Babies!



Everyone's
Welcome!

An Original
Production of
Minnehaha United
Methodist Church

Sunday, December 16 @ 4:00 PM

⇒ Join us for dinner after the pageant! ⇐



CHRISTMAS POINSETTIAS

It is Minnehaha tradition to decorate our sanctuary with poinsettias for the week of Christmas. If you would like to be part of this, complete the order form below and bring it to the church office (or drop it in an offering basket). The cost is \$14 per poinsettia (6.5" pot single red poinsettia). You may take your plant home after the 10pm Christmas Eve Service.

Orders should be turned in by December 9 at noon.

Name: _____

Phone: _____

Please dedicate this plant in: (select one) Honor Celebration Memory Other

of: _____



ORDER YOUR
POINSETTIAS



Toy Drive

Some of the comments we every year are "Thank you, thank you" and "Oh my gosh these presents are so nice." and "Can I really get a hat and gloves for each child?"

During the 4 Tuesdays before Christmas Food Self Parents are able to select toys for their children ranging from baby toys to dolls to hot wheels to table foosball to hair dryers and clock radios for older children. Each child received a toy, a stocking stuffer and a hat and or gloves if needed. We also had gift bags and wrapping paper. All this is made possible by the generosity of members of Minnehaha.

There are three ways to help with this mission

Buy toys and bring them to church

Designate an offering for toys in the Sunday offering

Donate cash to be used for toys

With your help Good things will happen here

Pledges

If you haven't gotten in your pledges for both the 2019 Operating Budget and the 2019-2021 Capital Campaign, please do so right away. We will be passing our budget on January 20, and we'd like as accurate a number as we can for our income so that we don't unnecessarily make cuts in vital programming for the church. If you need new pledge cards, please contact the office.

Christmas Eve

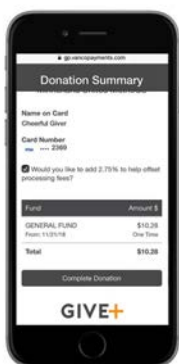
Please join us, and invite your friends and neighbors, for Christmas Eve services this year. We'll have a more informal service at 4:00 p.m. featuring music with The Methodicals and a more traditional candlelight service with choir and organ at 10:00 p.m.

Food Ministries

MUMC has a number of food ministries, and we support two of them financially. MinneHarvest is a monthly free food giveaway, and our Food Shelf is a weekly food shelf for residents in our neighborhood, supported by us, Lake Nokomis Lutheran, and St. James Episcopal on the Parkway. Both of these ministries need regular financial support in order for them to continue to provide food to those in need. Please consider making a regular contribution to one or both of these ministries; you can use the handy envelopes provided in the pews, or you can write a check and indicate either MinneHarvest or Food Shelf on the memo line.

If you would like to volunteer your time, the Food Shelf and MinneHarvest have plenty of spaces for volunteers. We can also use volunteers for two of our other food ministries, Meals on Wheels and serving a meal at Simpson Housing Services. You can contact Rachel Larson to volunteer for Meals on Wheels, and Maureen Trepp for the next SHS meal date.

Give+ App Makes Giving Easy

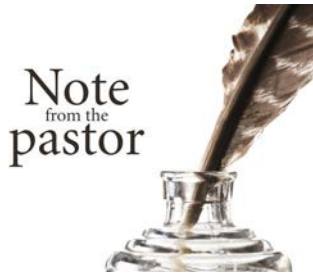


Give+ is an easy way to support Minnehaha UMC. Just download the app, set up an account and you can make a one-time gift or set up regular giving in any amount you choose. Thank you!



Download it
from Apple's
App Store or
Google Play





Singing of God

Mary's Song, or the Magnificat, is the poem found in Luke 1:46-55. It is a poem about the effects of the Lord's coming for all of God's people. Almost all the texts in the lectionary at Advent look to the day of God's return. Whether that is the first coming of the Messiah anticipated by the Jewish people or the second return of Christ anticipated by Christians, that is the focus of those texts. Since Advent anticipates the birth of Jesus, we (well, at least I) want texts that lead up to the birth of Jesus. But, there are very few of those. The birth story of Jesus is encompassed almost entirely by the passages we read on Christmas Eve. Mary's visit to Elizabeth is one of the very few things we have. What's interesting about this text, however, is that it talks about God's redeeming work not as something that will happen in the future, but instead as something that has already been fulfilled. Such is the nature of Mary's faith – that she can see God's work already done when it is still in progress. It's actually a pretty good practice for all of us. Pregnant with a child her fiancé knew was not his, Mary could still see God at work. So, where can we see God at work around us? Where is God already present? If the future will hold the fulfillment of God's desires, what slices of that are already here? When you find those places, people, times, sing out in song! We are in good company.

In Joy,

Becky



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12/18



Come Deck the Halls of Minnehaha UMC!

(Fa La La La La)

Saturday, December 1 • 9:30 – 11:30 a.m.

Join us on Saturday morning, December 1, from 9:30 to 11:30 a.m. to prepare Minnehaha UMC for the joyous season of Advent.



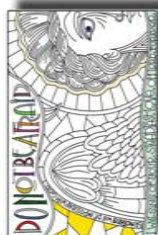
Go on a Christmas tree pilgrimage. (It's not that far.)



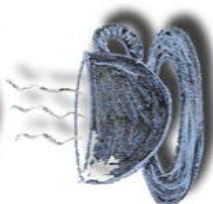
Sing your favorite Christmas carols.



Decorate the Sanctuary, Narthex, and Fellowship Hall. (Meet new people! Have fun!)



Color Christmas-themed murals in the Narthex.



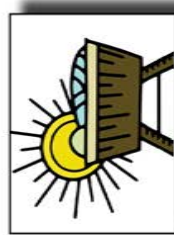
Find inner peace and good cheer with doughnuts, coffee, and hot cocoa.



Fold origami stars. (No experience necessary.)



Bring cookie dough or ingredients (or 8-10 dozen already-made cookies). At noon after baking, we'll trade and also set some aside to give as Christmas gifts to the homebound.



Paint amazing non-permanent Christmas scenes on the front windows.



All ages are welcome. (And invited!)